



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Veritas Academy
School Website: <https://codyveritas.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Veritas Academy (Cody, WY, 82414) (Cody, WY) emerges as a private Christian classical school with a clearly articulated religious and classical orientation, strong parental engagement, and a practice-oriented pedagogy centered on memorization, chant, and a curriculum described as "classical." Public-facing materials emphasize Biblical truth, a Christ-centered mission, and a governance model that includes parent/community oversight. While the school demonstrates many hallmarks of classical education (religious foundation, formation-focused language, a Classical delivery emphasis, and a partnership with families), explicit commitments to core classical curriculum elements such as the Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books/Great Conversation, and formal Socratic pedagogy across grade bands are not uniformly stated on the public site. Based on a category-by-category keyword analysis aligned to the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School, the school presents a strong classical posture in some categories but shows more limited explicit alignment in others. Overall classification: **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**.

Key reasons: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are strongly present: Biblical truth, Christian framing, prayer/moral formation language, and a Statement of Faith are foregrounded on public pages. Evidence includes "Biblical Truth | Classical Way | Abundant Life" and explicit references to a Christian, classical education, plus statements about mission/vision and ACCS membership. - Purpose and Goal emphasize formation, virtue, and transcendentals in public language (e.g., Christ-centered, formation-focused tone, and partnership with families), but explicit, fully articulated philosophical grounding around truth/beauty/virtue as universal, knowable ideals is less overt in the site prose than in the canonical Six Elements document. Still, the alignment is meaningful and formation-focused. - Curriculum shows classical intent (private, Christian, Latin study; "classical delivery"); however, explicit mentions of the Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, and Great Conversation are not clearly stated on the public pages. The site does emphasize Bible and Latin and a classical approach, and the ACCS affiliation supports a classical framing. - Pedagogy incorporates contemplative/restful elements and memory-centered practices (chant, memorization) in the public materials; there is also mention of "classical delivery" and, in parental quotes, the ancient-method feel of chant and recitation. Explicit high-school-level Socratic/seminar pedagogy is not clearly described in the public materials. This yields a mixed score leaning toward **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**. - Faculty portrayal is less explicit in the public materials about the teachers as "living curriculum" or "model mentors," though there is emphasis on a governance board with parents and community members and a community-centered mission. This limits a full **CLASSICAL** categorization in this category. - Parents & Community are a clear strength: strong parent involvement/partnerships, a board including parents, and explicit openness to parents visiting; parent feedback highlights the role of families and prayer in daily school life. Public materials reflect a robust classical-community orientation.

What would move the needle section is provided below in the dedicated section after Element 6.

Note: All six categories were assessed against the keyword framework defined in the Six Essential Elements

of a Classical School (1) document, using the school's public materials as the primary data source, and the classical rubric as the reference. The positive/negative keyword indicators from that document were used to guide the scoring. Citations reference the relevant public materials in the school's crawl and the Six Essential Elements document.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize Biblical truth and Christian identity: "Biblical Truth | Classical Way | Abundant Life" and language describing Veritas as a private, Christian, classical educational experience. - Statement of Faith and Mission/Vision are highlighted as part of the school's public-facing materials, signaling theological grounding. - ACCS membership and references to a God-honoring, classical curriculum reflect a theologically anchored framework. - Parent feedback notes "open each school day in prayer," indicating liturgical/communal spiritual practices.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: truth, virtue, character (implied by moral formation), formation, spiritual depth, sacred tradition, prayer, and the phrase "Biblical Truth." The site uses explicit religious language and references to a Statement of Faith, aligning with multiple positive keywords in Element 1's rubric. Estimated positive keyword hits: 5–7. - Negative keywords observed: none detected in public materials. - Why this rating: The school foregrounds Biblical truth, Christian identity, and liturgical community life, which aligns strongly with the religious foundations expected in Classical definition. The absence of explicit counter-signals in the public materials pushes toward CLASSICAL, but the absence of detailed theological-doctrinal exposition or liturgical depth on the site pushes it slightly toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL. The strong religious framing nonetheless sustains a solid CLASSICAL orientation in practice.

Classification note from the rubric - The presence of Biblical truth, Christian worldview, and devotional practices aligns with the Positive/Negative keywords in the Six Elements list, indicating CLASSICAL potential, but because some elements (e.g., explicit liturgical rhythms or explicit theological integrations across disciplines) are not exhaustively documented in public pages, the rating remains SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Citations: Biblical Truth header and Christian framing; Statement of Faith; Mission & Vision; ACCS membership; daily prayer references.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents itself as aiming at formation and virtue within a Christian, classical framework, emphasizing character and transformation rather than mere information. Public materials describe a private, Christian, classical educational experience with a mission and vision rooted in faith. - The public narrative emphasizes "God-honoring, classical curriculum" and a partnership with families to sustain the mission—language aligned with formation-oriented aims rather than straightforward vocational preparation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, character, love of learning, gospel-centered formation, moral formation, beauty in learning, and truth/goodness/beauty framed as real ideals within a classical project. The site uses language consistent with forming the person, not just transmitting information. Estimated positive keyword hits: 4–6. - Negative keywords observed: none detected in public materials. - Why this rating: The emphasis on formation, virtue, moral development, and the belief in transcendentals aligns with the Classical concept of education as formation of the whole person. The absence of explicit counter-signals supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Citations: Mission/Vision, Statement of Faith, "God-honoring, classical curriculum," and partner-with-families language.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site notes a classical delivery in instruction and a curriculum described as private Christian and classical; it also specifies Bible and Latin as part of the Kindergarten–8th-grade program. - The school references “classical curriculum,” and ACCS membership supports a broader classical framework. However, there is not an explicit public listing of the Seven Liberal Arts or Great Books/Great Conversation on the public pages. - Public materials emphasize a focus on recitation/memorization and chanting as part of learning, which aligns with traditional classical pedagogy and memory work.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Bible and Latin; classical delivery; private Christian, classical education; classical curriculum; recitation/chant/memorization. These map to elements like grammar/logic/rhetoric and the Latin component of classical pedagogy in the Six Elements lexicon; memory/recitation aligns with the “Scholé” and “integration and wonder” themes. Estimated positive keyword hits: 3–5. - Negative keywords observed: explicit mention of Great Books, Great Conversation, or the Seven Liberal Arts and Quadrivium is not present in public content; there is no explicit articulation of those core liberal arts in the site copy. This yields a higher presence of missing explicit classical curriculum elements rather than explicit negatives. Estimated negative keyword hits: 1–2 (absence indicators for Great Books/Great Conversation and Seven Liberal Arts). - Why this rating: The school demonstrates clear classical affinities (classical delivery, private Christian, Latin, and a classical framing) but does not publicly enumerate the canonical core elements (Great Books, Great Conversation, Seven Liberal Arts) in its public-facing materials. This justifies a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation rather than CLASSICAL.

Citations: Bible/Latin and “classical delivery” language; absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation; ACCS membership.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes a classical delivery in instruction and uses memorization/chant in learning, as reflected in parent feedback and program descriptions. This indicates a pedagogical approach rooted in memory, recitation, and chant in lower grades. - Public materials also describe “private Christian, classical education,” suggesting a pedagogy that emphasizes classical methods rather than purely modern, project-based or purely test-driven approaches. - There is mention of a long-standing classical approach, with the potential for Socratic-style discussion in upper grades (the Six Elements framework references Socratic dialogue and great conversation; however, explicit classroom pedagogy like Socratic seminars are not documented on the public site).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: chant, memorization, recitation, memory, classical delivery, great conversation (implied via the classical framework and parent quotes), Socratic dialogue (documented in the Six Elements framework but not publicly evidenced in school site text), and upper-grade seminar potential (not explicitly shown on site). Estimated positive keyword hits: 2–5. - Negative keywords observed: The absence of explicit, uniform Socratic seminars across all grades on public pages lowers the pedagogy rating; there is no explicit mention of a full, high-school-grade Socratic program in the public-facing copy. Estimated negative keyword hits: 1–2. - Why this rating: Pedagogical methods show clear classical signals (recitation/memorization, chant, classical framing) but lack explicit, comprehensive evidence of advanced classical pedagogy (e.g., systematic Socratic seminars across upper grades and a fully documented “Scholé/restful” approach across the entire program) in public materials. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Memorization/chant; “classical delivery”; parent quotes about chant and memorization.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Governance appears to be board-centered with parent and community members, signaling a community-involved faculty/staff governance model rather than a purely teacher-led “living curriculum” emphasis. - Public materials emphasize partnerships with families and a role for parents in governance, rather than a fully articulated “living curriculum” portrayal of faculty as the primary curriculum. - There is mention

of “private Christian, classical education” and teachers/administration rightly described as implementing a classical approach; however, explicit statements about faculty as mentors, living curriculum, or a detailed teacher profile are not present in public-facing content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: “living curriculum,” “mentors,” “model teachers” (explicit phrases are not found on the site; the Six Elements doc provides these as ideal phrases, but not directly on the public site). The closest public signals are “board consisting of parents and community members” and “strong partnership with families.” Estimated positive keyword hits: 1–2 (implicit mentorship/teacher role inferred, not explicit). - Negative keywords observed: None overtly stated in public materials (no explicit negative statements about faculty). - Why this rating: The public content suggests a faculty and governance model that is family- and community-centric, with limited explicit portrayal of the faculty as the core living curriculum or as model mentors. This supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Faculty rather than CLASSICAL.

Citations: Board governance; partnership with families; “mission and vision” framing.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials repeatedly emphasize partnership with families and parent involvement. The governance structure is explicitly described as “Governed by a Board consisting of parents and community members.” The school states a strong partnership with families that sustains the operation and mission. There are clear invitations for parental involvement (mission/vision access, statement of faith, parent feedback, etc.). - Public pages and parent quotes highlight the role of parents as co-educators, the value of family involvement, and the daily practice of prayer, which frames parental engagement as integral to the educational project. The parent feedback page includes explicit statements about parental partnership and home-school collaboration, including the idea that Veritas partners with parents to raise Christian students. - The school places emphasis on inviting parents to visit and engage with school life (calendar, parent events, etc.). The “Open Board Meeting” page and event postings show ongoing public-facing parental access and involvement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, parent involvement, co-educators, home-school connection, living tradition in the family, parental leadership, engaged families, school-parent synergy, family catechesis, etc. The public materials directly use or imply these terms. Estimated positive keyword hits: 6–9. - Negative keywords observed: none detected publicly; no explicit statements diminishing parental involvement. - Why this rating: The school’s public-facing materials present a robust, explicit, and ongoing partnership with parents and a welcoming stance toward parent participation, which aligns strongly with the Classical rubric for parents/community.

Citations: Board governance by parents and community; parent feedback; “mission & vision” and “statement of faith” pages; parental involvement language.

What Would Move the Needle

- Expand explicit articulation of core classical curriculum elements on public pages (e.g., Seven Liberal Arts, Grammar-Logic-Rhetoric, Quadrivium, and Great Books/Great Conversation) to strengthen Element 3 (Curriculum) and Element 4 (Pedagogy) alignment publicly.
- Add explicit language and examples of Socratic discourse or seminar-style learning across upper grades (even if capped by current grade levels) to strengthen Element 4 and Element 3 alignment.
- Publish a formal “Living Curriculum” statement for Faculty (and/or teacher profiles) to elevate Element 5 toward CLASSICAL by presenting faculty as mentors who embody the curriculum and virtue in practice.
- Provide a public foundation for “Scholé: restful learning” (including pace, contemplative time, and a clear stance on the balance between contemplation and rigor) to bolster Element 4’s restful aspects and Element 3’s integration/wonder elements.
- Increase explicit Great Books/Great Conversation references, with a published reading list or core texts, to move Element 3 toward CLASSICAL and align more fully with the Six Elements framework.

- Continue and expand parent-education initiatives (book studies, gatherings) and transparent feedback loops to deepen Element 6 and further strengthen parental partnership.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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